SESSION 1 · UNIT A · UNDERSTANDING THE CUSTOMER

Customer Care in Context

Everything from Session 1. Keep it with your workbook to prepare for your exit ticket, the midterm and your capstone.

By the end of this session, you can

Explain what customer care means and who the customer is

Analyse how good service leads to profit, using the Service-Profit Chain

Describe what customers expect across today's channels, including AI

Level 4 and Level 5: what changes

	Level 4	Level 5 (this course)
Your role	Deliver good service	Manage and improve service
Your thinking	Explain and apply	Analyse, evaluate and justify
Example	Handle a complaint well	Find why complaints happen, compare solutions, recommend one

Key terms

Term	Meaning	Example
Customer care	Looking after customers before, during and after a sale	Calling a customer to check the problem is solved
Customer experience	How the customer feels about every contact with the business	"The website was easy, but the delivery was late."
External customer	A person or business that buys from you	A guest checking in at a hotel
Internal customer	A colleague or team that depends on your work	The kitchen depends on the waiter's orders
Touchpoint	Any point where a customer meets the business	The app, the phone call, the receptionist
Customer retention	Keeping customers so they come back again	A family returns to the same restaurant every week
ROI	Return on investment: what you gain compared with what you spend	Training cost QAR 5,000 and brought QAR 8,000
Omnichannel	All channels connected, so the customer gets one smooth experience	The agent can see your WhatsApp message during a call

CORE CONTENT

Customer care covers every contact

Customer care is how an organisation looks after its customers **before, during and after** the sale.

Before
Answering enquiries, giving clear information, making it easy to buy

During
Delivering the product or service well, with a positive attitude

After
Following up, handling problems and complaints, keeping in touch

Service, care and experience are not the same

	Customer service	Customer care	Customer experience
What it is	Helping a customer at one moment	Looking after the customer over time	The customer's total feeling about the business
Who owns it	Frontline staff	The whole team	The whole organisation, led by managers
Example	Answering a question at the counter	Calling back to check the problem is solved	Website, staff, waiting time and follow-up together

Two kinds of customer

External customer
Buys from the organisation.

Example: a guest checking in at a hotel.

Internal customer
A colleague who depends on your work.

Example: housekeeping needs the front desk to report check-outs quickly.

Remember: poor service to internal customers becomes poor service to external customers.

Customer care must be managed

Know
Understand what customers need

Lead
Set standards and train the team

Measure
Track performance with data

Improve
Fix problems and keep customers

These four match the four units of this course.

Why customer care matters

Customers return
Repeat customers bring steady income.

Customers recommend you
Word of mouth and online reviews bring new customers.

Costs go down
Fewer complaints, refunds and repeated work.

You stand out
When products are similar, service makes the difference.

Poor service costs the business money

65%
of lost business comes from staff who seem uninterested or do not meet customers' needs

10
people typically hear about it when a customer is unhappy. Online, it spreads in one click.

5%
fewer customers leaving can raise profit by 25% to 85% (Harvard Business Review)

Good customer care costs no more than bad customer care. Most unhappy customers leave without telling you why.

Source: Wellington, P. (2010) Effective Customer Care. Level 5 question: these figures are from 2010. Are they higher or lower today, with social media? Give a reason.

Service quality depends on your people

Front-line staff
Have the main responsibility for taking care of customers

Everyone in the chain
Affects service through their attitude and enthusiasm

The manager
Makes sure service is outstanding, not just adequate

The goal: move from **service provider** to **service partner**, the customer's first choice.

LEVEL 5 MODEL

The Service-Profit Chain

1. Good support for staff › 2. Satisfied, loyal staff › 3. Better service value › 4. Satisfied customers › 5. Loyal customers › 6. Profit and growth

The chain starts with **staff**, not customers. If one link is weak, the whole chain is weak.

Use it in three steps

1. **Start at the end:** what result does the business want?
2. **Find the weak link:** go back through each link and look for evidence.
3. **Recommend and justify:** fix the weakest link first, and explain why.

Level 5 reading

Heskett and colleagues (1994), Harvard Business Review, studied successful service companies. Profit and growth came mainly from **loyal customers**, and loyalty came from staff who were well supported, trained and satisfied.

Lesson: invest in your people first.

Service is an investment, not a cost

ROI = (Gain − Cost) ÷ Cost

Example figures: training costs QAR 5,000 and brings QAR 8,000 extra profit. ROI = 3,000 ÷ 5,000 = **60%**.

Worked example: a Doha family restaurant

Link	What the manager sees
1 · Support for staff	New ordering app, but no training given
2 · Satisfied, loyal staff	Staff are stressed; two waiters resigned
3 · Service value	Slow service and wrong orders
4 · Satisfied customers	More complaints and lower online ratings
5 · Loyal customers	Regular families visit less often
Analysis	**Weakest link: 1. Recommend one day of app training, because every later problem starts there.**

Sentence frame: "The weakest link is ___ because ___. I recommend ___."

TECH LAYER

One customer, many channels

Face to face · Phone · WhatsApp · Email · Website · Mobile app · Social media · Chatbot

Multichannel
Many channels, not connected. The customer repeats their story every time.

Omnichannel
Channels connected. Staff see the history, so the customer explains once.

What customers expect now

24/7
Help at any time

Fast
A quick first reply, then a clear time to solve

Mobile
Everything works on a phone

Personal
The business knows my history

AI and people each have a job

AI handles

- Routine questions: opening hours, order status
- Sorting messages to the right team
- A first reply at any time of day

People handle

- Upset or emotional customers
- Complex problems with no standard answer
- Decisions about money or policy

The manager decides when AI passes the customer to a person. We design this in Session 9.

Case study: Grace and the phone shop

Grace buys a new phone from a shop in Doha. After three days, the screen stops working. She sends a WhatsApp message. Nobody replies for two days. She phones and waits 20 minutes, then is told to come in. At the shop, the staff have no record of her message, so she explains everything again. The same day, she writes a one-star online review. The manager added WhatsApp last month but did not decide who should answer it.

Questions: Which links are weak? Is the shop multichannel or omnichannel? What is the real cause? What should the manager do, and what is one risk?

CAPSTONE STEP 1

Analyse how service affects your organisation's profit

Your capstone is a **Digital-Ready Customer Care Improvement Plan** for one real organisation, built one step each session (35% of your grade). Write about 150 words.

1. Your organisation and its customers

"I chose ___. Its main external customers are ___. Its internal customers include ___."

2. One strong link and one weak link

"A strong link is ___. The evidence is ___. A weak link is ___. The evidence is ___."

3. How the weak link affects profit

"The weak link affects profit because ___."

Five things to remember

1. Customer care covers before, during and after the sale.
2. There are external and internal customers, and both matter.
3. Poor service costs money; good service costs no more than bad.
4. The Service-Profit Chain starts with staff: fix the weakest link first.
5. Customers expect connected channels; AI handles routine, people handle the rest.

Before Session 2

- Finish Capstone Step 1
- Do the Session 1 e-workbook and practice quiz on the course app
- Complete the exit ticket

Course app

learnovateqa.github.io/Customer_Care_Management_Academy

Sign in with your access code.